

Pecan Pie, the Standard

A family recipe that travels to the office

The standard pecan pie, the one that travels well to the office on a Monday morning.

Ingredients

Ingredient	Amount
Pie crust, nine inch, chilled	1
Pecan halves	1.5 cups
Light corn syrup	1 cup
Packed brown sugar	1 cup
Large eggs	3
Butter, melted	4 tablespoons
Vanilla	1 teaspoon
Salt	0.5 teaspoon

Method

Step	What to do
1	Preheat the oven to 350 degrees Fahrenheit
2	Whisk corn syrup, brown sugar, eggs, butter, vanilla, and salt until smooth
3	Arrange the pecan halves evenly across the crust
4	Pour the filling over the pecans so they float to the top
5	Bake for 55 minutes until the center is set with a slight jiggle
6	Cool completely before slicing

Baker's notes

- A slight jiggle at the center means it will set as it cools; an over baked pie cracks.
- Cool it fully, ideally a few hours, before the first clean slice.
- Save it for birthdays and holidays when cooking for Linda, since it runs high in sugar.
- Doubles easily for a Sunday dinner crowd or a plate for the office.

Make ahead and storage

The pie keeps well, which is what makes it a good Monday treat for the office. Bake it the day before, cool it fully, and cover it once it reaches room temperature. It holds two days on the counter and up to four in the refrigerator, and a few minutes in a warm oven brings back the just baked edge.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Try this next time
The center stays runny	Bake a few minutes longer and check for the slight jiggle
The top cracks	Pull it earlier; it is likely over baked
The crust browns too fast	Shield the edge with foil for the last fifteen minutes
The filling is too sweet	Cut the brown sugar slightly and add a pinch more salt

A note from the kitchen

This is the recipe that travels. A midnight batch is the tell of a hard week, and the kitchen is where it settles. The grandmother's cast iron and a good sheet pan do most of the heavy lifting, and the office always finishes the plate by lunch.

Cool it fully before the first slice. The patience is the whole secret.